tubectomy (ligation of fallopian tube). These are methods of permanent birth control.

17.13 Urinary Tract Infection (UTI)

Many diseases affect both women and men, but a few diseases occur at a higher frequency in woman. Woman are susceptible to UTI from the bacteria that are present on skin, rectum or vagina. This will enter the urethra, before moving upwards. The types of UTI are:

1. Cystitis or Bladder infection

Bacteria lodged in the urinary bladder thrive and multiply leading to **inflammation**. It is most common in the age group of 20 to 50.

2. Kidney Infection

The bacteria can travel from the urinary bladder and upward to ureter and **affect one or both the kidneys**. It also **infects the blood stream** and leads to serious life-threatening complications.

3. Asymptomatic Bacteriuria

The bacteria present in the urinary bladder which may not show any symptoms.

17.14 Personal Hygiene

Hygiene is the practice of healthy living and personal cleanliness. Personal hygiene is caring of one's own body and health. Social hygiene is proper care of the surrounding environment. The main aspect of hygiene are body hygiene, food hygiene, sanitary hygiene and hygienic environment.

17.14.1 Body Hygiene

Washing is vital to all age group of people which maintains our personal hygiene. A daily bath regularly keeps skin clean and free of germs. Hair should be kept clean by frequent washing. Mouth wash should be done after every meal. We should wash our hands many times during the day.

Cloth towels used to dry our hands or body should be dried after each use and laundered regularly. Clothes, handkerchief, undergarments and socks should be washed daily. Washing prevents body odour, infections and skin irritation.

17.14.2 Toilet Hygiene

The toilet has a lot to do with personal hygiene and general health as it is a place that cannot be avoided and used regularly. Parents should guide and practice their children on how to use the toilets at home, in schools and other public places so that it will protect the children from various contagious infections and diseases.The following measures can ensure toilet hygiene

1. The floors of the toilet should be maintained clean and dry. This helps to reduce the bad odour and also infection.
2. Toilet flush handles, door knobs, faucets, paper towel dispensers, light switches and walls should be cleaned with disinfectants to kill harmful germs and bacteria.
3. Hands should be washed thoroughly with soap before and after toilet use.

17.14.3 Menstrual and Napkin Hygiene

Women's health depends upon the level of cleanliness to keep them free from skin and genitourinary tract infection.

Menstrual hygiene

Maintaining menstrual hygiene is important for the overall health of women. The basic menstrual hygiene ways are

1. Sanitary pads should be changed regularly, to avoid infections due to microbes from vagina and sweat from genitals.
2. Use of warm water to clean genitals helps to get rid of menstrual cramps.

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